

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 25

The use of Dama'ir in the Murakkab Idafi

1. A recap of the Murakkab Idafi

A construction of at least two nouns in which one noun is related to another, or a connection is established between one noun and another, is called a *Murakkab Idafi*.

- The noun that is related is called the *Mudaf*.
- The noun to which the relation is made is called the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

2. The use of Dama'ir in the Murakkab Idafi

The governing principle: In a *Murakkab Idafi*, *dama'ir* are used in the position of the *Mudaf Ilayh*. And since the *Mudaf Ilayh* is always *Majroor*, it is the *Majroor dama'ir* that will come here. These are always written joined to the word, which is why they are called *Muttasil dama'ir*.

In technical terms these are called the *Dameer Majroor Muttasil*. A *Dameer Majroor Muttasil* is one that is joined to its governing word and falls in the position of *jarr*. It always comes as a *Mudaf Ilayh* or as the *majroor* of a *Harf ul Jarr*.

3. The table of the Muttasil Majroor Dama'ir

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	هُ his	هُمَا of those two	هُمْ of them all
Mu'annath Gha'ib	هَا her	هُمَا of those two	هِنَّ of them all
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	كَ your	كُما of you two	كُمْ of you all
Mu'annath Mukhatab	كِ your	كُما of you two	كُنَّ of you all

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mutakallim	يَ my	—	نَا our

4. The difference between Marfoo' and Muttasil Majroor Dama'ir

The *Marfoo' dama'ir* are used separately in a sentence, as in هُوَ كِتَابٌ. Against this, when the *dama'ir* attach themselves to the end of a noun they become *Majroor dama'ir*, as in كِتَابُهُ and رُبُّهُمَا.

Form	Marfoo' Munfasil	Majroor Muttasil	Example
singular masculine Gha'ib	هُوَ	هُ	كِتَابُهُ
singular feminine Gha'ib	هِيَ	هَا	كِتَابُهَا
singular masculine Mukhatab	أَنْتَ	كَ	كِتَابُكَ
singular feminine Mukhatab	أَنْتِ	كِ	كِتَابُكِ
singular Mutakallim	أَنَا	يَ	كِتَابِي
plural Mutakallim	نَحْنُ	نَا	كِتَابُنَا

5. Determining the I'raab

Rule: The *I'raab* of a *Murakkab Idafi* is determined by the *I'raab* of the *Mudaf*. In the same way, when *dama'ir* are used in a *Murakkab Idafi*, the *I'raab* is still determined by the *I'raab* of the *Mudaf*.

Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
رَبَّنَا	رَبَّنَا	رَبَّنَا
أَعْمَالُهُمْ	أَعْمَالُهُمْ	أَعْمَالِهِمْ

Look closely at the second row: in the *Majroor* state it is أَعْمَالِهِمْ, that is, the *dameer* هُمْ has changed to هِمَّ. The reason for this is set out in section 8.

6. Complete drills

With the word Rabb

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	رَبُّهُ	رَبُّهُمَا	رَبُّهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	رَبُّهَا	رَبُّهُمَا	رَبُّهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	رَبُّكَ	رَبُّكُمَا	رَبُّكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	رَبُّكِ	رَبُّكُمَا	رَبُّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	رَبِّي	—	رَبُّنَا

(his Lord · the Lord of those two · their Lord ... my Lord · our Lord)

With the word Kitab

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	كِتَابُهُ	كِتَابُهُمَا	كِتَابُهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	كِتَابُهَا	كِتَابُهُمَا	كِتَابُهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	كِتَابُكَ	كِتَابُكُمَا	كِتَابُكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	كِتَابُكِ	كِتَابُكُمَا	كِتَابُكُنَّ
Mutakallim	كِتَابِي	—	كِتَابُنَا

7. The rules for reading the Dameer -hu

The *dameer* of the singular masculine *Gha'ib*, **أ**, has various ways of being written and read. What decides the form is the vowel or letter that comes before it.

What precedes the Dameer	Form of the Dameer	Examples
a fathah or a dammah	inverted dammah — هـ	كِتَابُهُ ، مَدِينَتُهُ
a kasrah	standing kasrah — هـ	رُسُلِهِ ، كُتُبِهِ
a silent yaa'	plain kasrah — هـ	فِيهِ ، أَخِيهِ
any other silent letter, or an alif	plain dammah — هـ	مِنْهُ ، كِتَابَاهُ

- Both the inverted dammah and the standing kasrah are read **drawn out to the length of one alif**.
- The plain kasrah and the plain dammah are not drawn out.

The difference between the Indian and Saudi Mushaf

In the Mushaf of the Indian subcontinent the standing kasrah **اِ** and the inverted dammah **اُ** are written so that these vowels are plainly visible. In the Saudi Mushaf, that of the *Rasm 'Uthmani*, the same thing is written somewhat differently.

- inverted dammah = plain dammah + a small waw
- standing kasrah = plain kasrah + a small yaa'

Important points

- The standing vowels are read somewhat longer than the plain ones.
- When the inverted and standing vowels are joined to what follows, they become plain.

For instance, in **يُنْيَتُهُ**, when it is joined to another word that follows, the standing kasrah disappears and turns into an ordinary kasrah, and in reading too the plain kasrah is pronounced: **يُنْيَتُهُ الْجَدِيدُ**.

8. The change in Huma, Hum and Hunna

Rule: The *dama'ir* of the state of *jarr* — هُنَّ ، هُمْ ، هُمَا — are also read and written with a change. The rule is that if a **kasrah** or a **silent yaa'** comes before them, they are read and written respectively as هُنَّ ، هُمْ ، هُمَا.

Dual	Masculine plural	Feminine plural
بِهِمَا	بِهِمْ	بِهِنَّ

Dual	Masculine plural	Feminine plural
عَلَيْهِمَا	عَلَيْهِمْ	عَلَيْهِنَّ

In the first row the change came about because of the kasrah on **بِ**, and in the second because of the silent yaa' in **عَلِي**.

9. The Yaa' ul Mutakallim

The *dameer* of the singular *Mutakallim* is called the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*. It demands a kasrah on the letter before it, and the noun meets that need.

An important consequence: Since the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* demands a kasrah before it, whenever it is used in a *Murakkab Idafi* the construction keeps **one and the same form** in all three states of I'raab.

State	The joining	Result
Halat ur Raf'	كِتَابُ + يِ	كِتَابِي
Halat un Nasb	كِتَابَ + يِ	كِتَابِي
Halat ul Jarr	كِتَابٍ + يِ	كِتَابِي

When the Yaa' ul Mutakallim takes a fathah

There are a few cases in which the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* itself takes a fathah.

- When a *Tathniyah* or a *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar* is annexed to it:

$$\begin{array}{ll} \text{كِتَابَانِ} + \text{يِ} = \text{كِتَابَايَ} & \text{بَنُونَ} + \text{يِ} = \text{بَنِيَّ} \\ \text{كِتَابَيْنِ} + \text{يِ} = \text{كِتَابَيْيَ} & \text{بَنَيْنَ} + \text{يِ} = \text{بَنِيَّ} \end{array}$$

- When an alif comes before the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*: عَصَايَ
- When it is joined to what follows: رَبِّيَ اللَّهُ
- Though it may also be joined without the fathah: عَهْدِي الظَّالِمِينَ

The reason: In all these cases two silent letters would come together, and Arabic dislikes the meeting of two silent letters. The *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* is therefore given a fathah to make it voweled.

10. Ila, 'Ala and Lada with a Dameer

Rule: When a *dameer* is joined to **إِلَى**, **عَلَى** or **لَدَى**, their **alif** changes into a **yaa'**.

Original	With a Gha'ib Dameer	With a Mukhatab Dameer	Translation
إِلَى	إِلَيْهِ	إِلَيْكَ	towards him · towards you
عَلَى	عَلَيْهِ	عَلَيْكَ	upon him · upon you
لَدَى	لَدَيْهِ	لَدَيْكَ	with him · with you

This is why the *dameer* **هُمْ** coming after these words also becomes **هُمُ**, since a silent yaa' now stands before it: **عَلَيْهِمُ** and **إِلَيْهِمُ**.

11. Mudaf ila al-Ma'rifah

Rule: Whenever a *Nakirah* noun is joined to any one of the first five categories of the *Ma'rifah* — the *Ism ul 'Alam*, the *Ism ud Dameer*, the *Ism ul Isharah*, the *Ism ul Mawsul* and the *Mu'arraf bil Lam* — that *Nakirah* noun too becomes *Ma'rifah*. This is called *Mudaf ila al-Ma'rifah*, and it is the **sixth category of the Ma'rifah**.

The joining	Kind of Mudaf Ilayh	Result
وَلَدٌ + حَامِدٍ	Ism ul 'Alam	وَلَدٌ حَامِدٍ
وَلَدٌ + هُ	Ism ud Dameer	وَلَدُهُ
وَلَدٌ + هَذَا	Ism ul Isharah	وَلَدٌ هَذَا
وَلَدٌ + الَّذِي	Ism ul Mawsul	وَلَدُ الَّذِي
وَلَدٌ + الْمُسْلِمِ	Mu'arraf bil Lam	وَلَدُ الْمُسْلِمِ

In all these examples the word **وَلَدٌ**, which was originally *Nakirah*, has now become *Ma'rifah*.

12. Practical application from Surah 'Abasa

يَوْمَ يَفِرُّ الْمَرْءُ مِنْ أَخِيهِ * وَأُمِّهِ وَأَبِيهِ * وَصَاحِبَتِهِ وَبَنِيهِ *

(Surah 'Abasa: 34 to 36)

Translation: On the day a man will flee from his brother, and his mother and his father, and his wife and his sons.

Word	What precedes the Dameer	Its effect
أَخِيهِ	a silent yaa'	a plain kasrah is written, and it is not drawn out
وَأُمِّهِ	a kasrah on the meem	a standing kasrah is written, and it is read drawn out
وَأَبِيهِ	a silent yaa'	a plain kasrah has been used
وَصَاحِبَتِهِ	a kasrah on the taa'	a standing kasrah is written, and it is read drawn out
وَبَنِيهِ	a silent yaa'	a plain kasrah is written, not drawn out

A second aspect: All these nouns — brother, mother, father, wife and sons — have become *Ma'rifah* by being annexed to a *dameer*. So a single passage displays both the rules for reading the *dameer* and the working of *Mudaf ila al-Ma'rifah*.

13. Further examples from the Qur'an

رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي * وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي * وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِّنْ لِّسَانِي * يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي *

(Surah Ta-Ha: 25 to 28)

Translation: My Lord, expand for me my breast, and make my task easy for me, and untie the knot from my tongue, that they may understand my speech.

The *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* occurs five times in this du'a: قَوْلِي ، لِسَانِي ، أَمْرِي ، صَدْرِي and لِي. In every case a kasrah stands on the letter before it.

خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ وَعَلَى سَمْعِهِمْ وَعَلَى أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 7)

Translation: Allah has set a seal upon their hearts and upon their hearing, and over their eyes is a covering.

In all three places the *dameer* هَمْ has come, not هُمْ — because in each case a kasrah stands before it.

لَنْ تُغْنِيَ عَنْهُمْ أَمْوَالُهُمْ وَلَا أَوْلَادُهُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ شَيْئًا

(Surah Al 'Imran: 10)

Translation: Their wealth and their children will not avail them anything against Allah.

Here in **أَمْوَالُهُمْ** and **أَوْلَادُهُمْ** the *dameer* **هُم** stands in its original form, because a dammah precedes it and not a kasrah.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ رَبِّي وَرَبُّكُمْ فَاعْبُدُوهُ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 51)

Translation: Indeed Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him.

إِنَّمَا بَغْيُكُمْ عَلَى أَنْفُسِكُمْ

(Surah Yunus: 23)

Translation: Your rebellion is only against yourselves.

14. Some further rules of the Dameer

14.1 Agreement of the Dameer with its Marja'

The noun to which a *dameer* refers back is called its *Marja'*. A *dameer* always agrees with its *Marja'* in being singular, dual or plural, and in gender.

A fine point: Only the *Dameer Gha'ib* has a *Marja'*. The *dameer* of the *Mutakallim* and the *Mukhatab* has none, since the speaker and the one addressed are themselves present.

14.2 Dameer ush Shan and Dameer ul Qissah

Sometimes a *Dameer Gha'ib* comes at the beginning of a sentence with no *Marja'* mentioned before it; rather, the sentence that follows explains it.

- If this *dameer* is masculine it is called the *Dameer ush Shan*, as in **هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ**.
- And if it is feminine it is called the *Dameer ul Qissah*, as in **فَإِنَّهَا لَا تَعْمَى الْأَبْصَارُ**.

14.3 Dameer Mubham

If the *Marja'* of a pronoun is neither mentioned before nor explained by the sentence that follows, the pronoun is called *Dameer Mubham*. In such a case a clarification or a *tamyeez* is brought after the pronoun to remove the ambiguity.

فَسَوُّهُنَّ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 29)

Here **هُنَّ** is a *Dameer Mubham*, and **سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ** is its *tamyeez*, which removes the ambiguity.

14.4 Nun ul Wiqayah

The *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* demands a kasrah before it. A noun meets that need by itself, but a verb cannot, since the final letter of a verb does not accept a kasrah. A noon is therefore brought between the verb and the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*, called the *Nun ul Wiqayah* — the noon of protection, which protects the verb's final letter from the kasrah.

- **ضَرَبَ + نِي = ضَرَبَنِي** — he struck me
- **أَنْعَمْتُ + عَلَيَّ** — with a noun no Nun ul Wiqayah is needed

A comparison: With a noun: **كِتَابِي** — no noon is needed, since the noun takes the kasrah itself. With a verb: **ضَرَبَنِي** — the *Nun ul Wiqayah* is obligatory.

14.5 Dameer ul Fasl

When both the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* are *Ma'rifah*, a pronoun is brought between them, called the *Dameer ul Fasl* — the pronoun of separation. Its benefit is that it makes clear that the noun following the *Mubtada* is its *Khabar* and not its *Sifah*.

اَلْعَالِمُ هُوَ الْعَامِلُ بِعِلْمِهِ

(the scholar is the one who acts upon his knowledge)

Had هُوَ not been there, اَلْعَامِلُ could have been taken as a *Sifah* of اَلْعَالِمُ, and the sense would have been left incomplete.

Another possibility: The *Dameer ul Fasl* may also be made a *Mubtada*. In اُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ, اُولَئِكَ may be the first *Mubtada* and هُمُ the second; or اُولَئِكَ the *Mubtada* and هُمُ a *Dameer ul Fasl*. Both parsings are sound.

Summary

1. In a Murakkab Idafi the dama'ir are used in the position of the Mudaf Ilayh.
2. Since the Mudaf Ilayh is always Majroor, it is the Majroor dama'ir that come here.
3. These dama'ir are always written joined to the word, which is why they are called Muttasil dama'ir.
4. The Marfoo' dama'ir are used separately in a sentence, while the Majroor dama'ir attach to the end of a noun.
5. Against Marfoo' هُوَ stands Majroor هُ; against هِىَ stands هِا; against أَنْتَ stands لَک; and against أَنَا stands the Yaa' ul Mutakallim.
6. Even when a dameer is present, the I'raab of a Murakkab Idafi is still determined by the Mudaf.
7. If a fathah or dammah precedes the dameer هُ, an inverted dammah هُ is written and read drawn out to one alif.
8. If a kasrah precedes it, a standing kasrah هِ is written, and this too is read drawn out.
9. If a silent yaa' precedes it, a plain kasrah هِ comes, which is not drawn out.
10. If any other silent letter or an alif precedes it, a plain dammah هُ comes.
11. In the Indian Mushaf these vowels are written plainly; in the Saudi Mushaf the inverted dammah is written as a plain dammah with a small waw, and the standing kasrah as a plain kasrah with a small yaa'.
12. When the standing and inverted vowels are joined to what follows they become plain, as in يَنْتَبِهْ الْجَدِيدِ.
13. If a kasrah or a silent yaa' precedes هُمْ, هُمَا, and هُنَّ, they become هُمْ, هُمَا, and هُنَّ.
14. The Yaa' ul Mutakallim demands a kasrah before it, which is why the construction keeps one form in all three states: كَيْتَانِي.
15. The Yaa' ul Mutakallim takes a fathah with the Tathniyah and Jam' Salim Mudhakkar, after an alif, and when joined to what follows.
16. When a dameer joins عَلَى, إِلَى, and لَدَى, their alif changes into a yaa': إِلَيْهِ, عَلَيْهِ, لَدَيْهِ.
17. A Nakirah noun annexed to any of the first five categories of the Ma'rifah becomes Ma'rifah itself, and this is the sixth category of the Ma'rifah.
18. In Surah 'Abasa, أَخِيهِ and بَنِيهِ carry a plain kasrah because a silent yaa' precedes, while أُمِّهِ and صَاحِبَتِهِ carry a standing kasrah because a kasrah precedes.
19. A dameer always agrees with its Marja' in number and gender, and only the Dameer Gha'ib has a Marja'.
20. A pronoun with no Marja' at the start of a sentence is called Dameer ush Shan if masculine and Dameer ul Qissah if feminine.
21. The noon brought between a verb and the Yaa' ul Mutakallim is called the Nun ul Wiqayah, which protects the verb's final letter from a kasrah.
22. When both Muftada and Khabar are Ma'rifah, the pronoun brought between them is the Dameer ul Fasl, which makes clear that what follows is the Khabar and not a Sifah.

Exercise

1. Where are dama'ir used in a Murakkab Idafi, and which dama'ir come there?
 2. Write the complete table of the Muttasil Majroor dama'ir.
 3. Explain the difference between the Marfoo' and the Muttasil Majroor dama'ir with five examples.
 4. Form the constructions of every form with the words Rabb and Kitab.
 5. Write اَعْمَال with the plural masculine Gha'ib dameer in all three states of I'raab.
 6. Write all four rules for reading the dameer ُ, with examples.
 7. State the difference between the Indian and Saudi Mushaf in writing the standing kasrah and the inverted dammah.
 8. What happens to the standing vowels when joined to what follows? Give an example.
 9. When does هُمْ become هُم؟ Write two examples of each cause.
 10. Why does the construction keep one and the same form in all three states with the Yaa' ul Mutakallim?
 11. In which cases does the Yaa' ul Mutakallim take a fathah? Give an example of each.
 12. What change occurs when a dameer joins عَلَى, إِلَى and لَدَى?
 13. Define Mudaf ila al-Ma'rifah and explain all five cases with examples.
 14. Take all five words from the verses of Surah 'Abasa and give the reason for the form of the dameer in each.
 15. What is a Marja', and which dameer has one?
 16. Explain the difference between the Dameer ush Shan and the Dameer ul Qissah with examples.
 17. What is the Nun ul Wiqayah and why is it brought?
 18. Define the Dameer ul Fasl and state what benefit it gives.
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ